



Lesson Plan: Trash in the Ocean

Its impact and how you can help

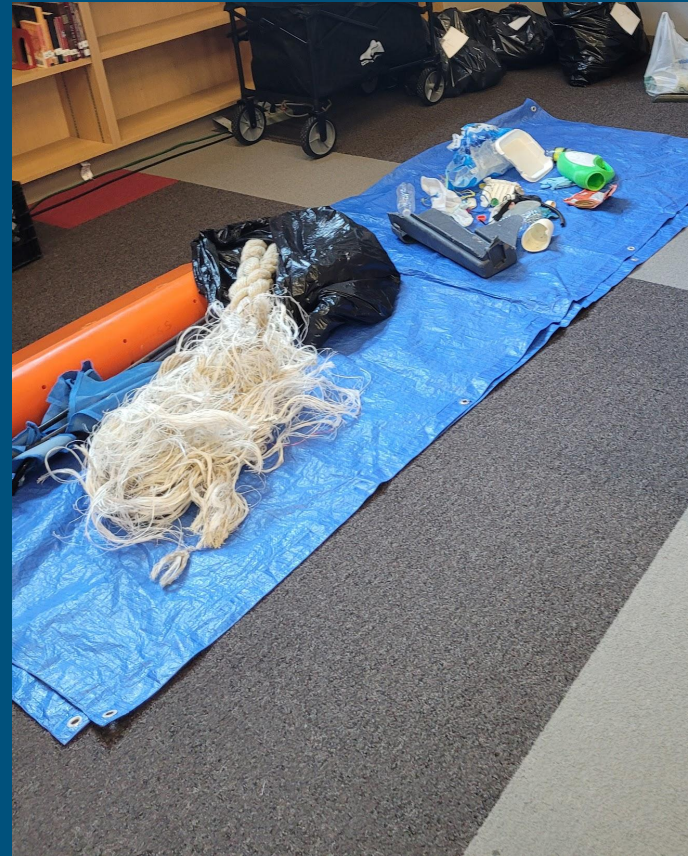


Objectives

- Students will learn about how trash is impacting coastal and marine habitats and the organisms living within them.
- Students will get involved and start looking through a new perspective with a hands on activity

Materials

- Trash
- Hot glue
- Glue dots
- Sharpies/markers
- Table clothes
- Tarp
- Gloves
- Trash bags



Collecting the Trash

Here are a couple different ideas for how you can get the trash to use in your classroom:

- Have your class go out and collect pieces of trash around the school (inside and/or outside it)
- Have your students bring in items from their trash at home
- Go on a field trip to do a beach cleanup or pick up trash in other areas in the community

Cleaning the Trash

However you get the trash, it will need to be cleaned before the activity. In order to do this, you will need gloves and bleach.

- Make sure to sort out the items that would be unusable or unsafe for students to work with: ex: weapons, rusty metal, anything that had barnacles (they can spread infection), paper products, etc.
- After sorting out those items, wash the rest of the trash off with water
- If there are pieces that have stuff on them that won't wash off (ex: algae), have a bucket filled with bleach to soak the items in
- After letting the trash that needed to be bleached soak for 10 minutes, rinse it off with water
- Leave all trash spread out in an area to dry

Procedure

This activity is at least a two day activity. You can switch the order you do things in whichever way you think your students will be most interested. They can go on a beach cleanup beforehand and they can build their sculptures out of what they collected after it has been cleaned, or you can go through the presentation and project and close out the activity with a beach cleanup.

These are the steps to the in the classroom day:

- Go through presentation
- Have students split into groups and let them pick out some trash to build sculptures



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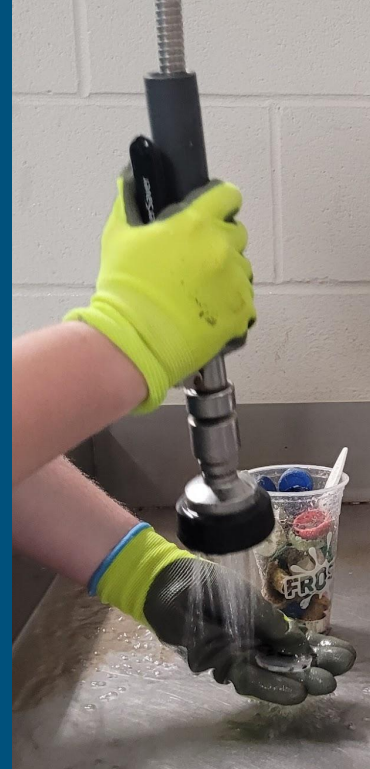
Albatross



Finding the Trash



Cleaning and sorting the trash



Examples

